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Engineering leader · 25+ years shipping production software · Builds the kitchen, not the dish: engineering systems where every engineer ships like several, with proof

SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 25+ years shipping production software and three Director of Engineering roles across aviation, IoT, and enterprise AI. At Parslee.AI I built the system that took one team's merged output from 59 pull requests a month to 505, with zero reverts, by giving engineers AI agent fleets that run under an independent reviewer, mandatory evidence gates, and a written authority model. The system is documented, public, and already adopted by engineers other than me. Most engineers improve their own output. I improve the system every engineer and every agent works inside, so the gain compounds after I leave the room. I can prove it inside one Axon squad in a quarter.

THE UNLOCK FOR AXON

- **Where the effort goes.** Strong engineers write good code. I write the definition of done before the code exists, encode every correction as a rule or a check so it never has to be made twice, and accept nothing on the author's word. That shift, from writing and reviewing to designing the kitchen the whole team cooks in, is what moves a squad from one-engineer output to department output. It is the same shift behind the engineers now shipping 2,000 verified pull requests a month at frontier AI labs, and it is teachable.
- **The result, in Axon terms.** Axon Records exists to get officers out from behind the desk. The limit on how fast that product improves is engineering throughput. The system I run took a team from 59 to 505 merged changes a month in twelve months. At a conservative third of that lift, a 10-engineer squad ships like 30, with no new headcount and every change verified before a customer sees it. [KEENAN: add the outcomes those changes produced; this is the line the VP will test.]
- **It survives a CJIS conversation.** Nothing merges on an agent's word. A separate reviewer re-runs the evidence, a bench must pass, anything user-facing is walked in a real browser before merge and again in production, and a person switches every release on. Consequential actions are sorted in writing into ask-first (9 kinds), never (1), do-then-tell (12), and just-do (8). In the last 30 days, 466 changes merged into the two main codebases with zero reverts and [N] production incidents.
- **It transfers.** I did not build a personal workflow. I built Wheelhouse, a public MIT template that installs a fleet into any repository in one session, plus a seven-stage path from "one agent" to "systems that build systems," each stage with an exit test. Teammates adopted it without me in the room. The first Axon squad becomes the template for the next ten.
- **It compounds.** Every correction goes into the fleet's standing brief, dated, in the engineer's words, or becomes a lint rule or bench check, so the same mistake stops recurring. The judgment that used to live in senior engineers' heads and in code-review comments lives in the codebase, the tests, and the shared contracts, and every new hire and every agent starts from it on day one.
- **Done is written first.** For anything larger than a routine change, agents write the outcomes and one yes/no check per outcome before a line of code exists. On September 18, five writer agents and a critic produced 235 outcomes and 215 checks for a code-review agent; 211 were met with evidence, six pull requests shipped, and a cross-vendor verifier found two critical security holes that nothing else caught.
- The cost is a rounding error against the salary line. The fleets run on about $1,800 a month in flat-rate subscriptions; at API list pricing the same volume would be roughly $ [X] K a month [KEENAN: Grace to compute], against the cost of the 25+ engineers the output would otherwise require.

WHAT I NEED FROM AXON

One squad, one quarter, and the authority to install the system. Remote, as I have led every team since 2018. Measure me on merged, verified, customer-facing change, and on whether the engineers on that squad want to keep working this way.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Parslee.AI — Director of Engineering Remote · Sep 2025 – Present

Parslee puts AI employees inside a company's Microsoft 365, each with a role, a level of authority, and a memory. Policy-gated agents acting on email, calendar, calls, CRM, and documents, the same trust problem a records or evidence platform has.

- Grew the team's merged output from 59 to 505 pull requests a month (3,100+ merged since September 2025) by building and rolling out agent-fleet delivery across five codebases. [KEENAN: the essay says 473 in 31 days; reconcile.]
- Built Wheelhouse, the public agent-fleet template (github.com/morebetterltd/wheelhouse) that turns a goal and its acceptance checks into builder, reviewer, and checker work, adopted by [N] engineers on the team.
- Contribute to CAR, the Common Agent Runtime that checks every proposed model action against policy before it runs, the control layer that lets AI act on customer data in a regulated enterprise. Built goalpool to queue and fail over agent work across accounts.
- Lead the engineering team [N engineers]: hiring, 1:1s, weekly priority-setting, and onboarding engineers onto fleet-based delivery [KEENAN: days to first production merge for the newest hire].

flyExclusive, Inc. — Director of Engineering Remote · Sep 2024 – Sep 2025

- Took the pilot mobile app from unused to installed and used regularly by every pilot [KEENAN: pilot count, and adoption or usage metric] by rebuilding it with a team of [N] engineers.

Volato, Inc. — Director of Software Engineering Remote · 2022 – Sep 2024

- Built and led a software engineering team of [N] across customer, crew, and internal systems [KEENAN: hires made, promotions].
- Delivered Fly Vaunt, an "empty leg" flight marketplace, generating $1.3M+ revenue and nearly 78,000 users in year one.
- Shipped Volato Mobile (11,000 users in six months) and the Volato Crew App for pilot scheduling (20 pilots in beta).

Agrify, Inc. — Director of Software Engineering Remote (Burlington, MA) · 2018 – 2022

- Led a team of [N] engineers building the Java IoT controllers that run Agrify's indoor farming units, maintaining 100% unit uptime.
- Helped build Agrify Insights, award-winning farm-operations software that reached 90% facility utilization, cut operating costs 30%, and ingests 1.5M+ data points per customer per year.

MoreBetter, Ltd. (Releaf) — Co-founder Washington, DC · 2015 – Present (part-time)

- Built Releaf, the top-rated cannabis journal on the App Store (4.7), to 100,000+ users; named inventor on US patent 11,253,195 B2; co-authored 15 published studies.

Automata Studios — Co-founder, CEO & Software Engineer Washington, DC · 2006 – 2019

- Grew a software and hardware studio to $10M+ revenue over 12 years delivering for IBM Watson, Frank Gehry, Victoria's Secret, Barnes & Noble, Adobe, and MTV. Architected and built the Kids' Reader on Barnes & Noble's NOOK.

WORK YOU CAN INSPECT

- Wheelhouse, agent-fleet template (public, MIT, comes with me): github.com/morebetterltd/wheelhouse
- How I build with agent fleets, a 12-minute written tour of the setup, the controls, and a seven-stage path any engineer can follow: claude.ai/artifact/Ut67onpaXX98VadmYvfEEe
- A live walk-through of the fleets at work, on request

SKILLS

AI engineering: agent fleets, Claude Code, Model Context Protocol, LLM integration, policy-gated agent runtimes

Languages and data: C#/.NET, Java, TypeScript/Node.js, Python/Django, Swift, PostgreSQL, SQL, Cosmos DB

Cloud: Azure, AWS, Microsoft 365/Graph · Front end and mobile: React/Next.js, React Native, iOS

Engineering practice: architecture reviews, CI/CD with mandatory test, lint, and supply-chain gates, high-availability services, mentoring

EDUCATION

University of Maryland, College Park: BS, Computer Science